



HIGHLIGHTS

- [NRA Press statement to prevent and control COVID-19, March 2020](#)
- [COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update](#)
- [International Conference update](#)
- [Important points to remember while going through the appeal process by the non-beneficiaries](#)
- [Norms for Rate Analysis of Retrofitting Masonry Building \(Draft Version\) drafted by the Retrofitting Technical Working Group](#)
- [The Urban Technical Working Group \(UR-TWG\)](#)

- Asia Shelter Forum 2020, Nepal preparation update

FEATURED STORY: A Journey of Devi Budhathoki as Social Mobilizer: Skilled Community Work to Personal Empowerment



Devi Budhathoki

*Social Mobilizer
Ward 2, Sunkoshi Rural
Municipality, Sindhupalchowk*

This edition of the bulletin features a story of **Devi Budhathoki, a Social Mobilizer from Sindhupalchowk** who has been playing a key role in the community in facilitating the ongoing reconstruction process after the 2015 Earthquake. She shares her experience on how she has been working as a bridge between the post-earthquake reconstruction program and the communities, as part of providing Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) in expediting the recovery and reconstruction process.

Originally from Balefi Rural Municipality-5, Fulpingdada, Sindhupalchowk, Devi Budhathoki is a Social Mobilizer in Ward 2, Thokarpa of Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchowk. She joined National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) Sindhupalchowk as a Social Mobilizer from January 2020.

Devi Budhathoki was one of the participants of a four-day training for “Social Mobilizers on earthquake resilient reconstruction” organized by the NRA and District Level Project Implementation Unit (DLPIU) Building in February 2020. She shares her journey as a social mobilizer on how it has not only increased her knowledge and skills on earthquake resilient reconstruction work, but has also been an enriching experience for her own personal development and empowerment.

PHOTO FEATURE



Ward 8, Shankarapur Municipality, Kathmandu: Two storey, stone in mud mortar house listed under retrofit grant scheme. The homeowner is a single woman with two children under 16 years old. The District Support Engineer suggested a jacketing of the structure, but the homeowner is unable to retrofit the house due to financial difficulties.

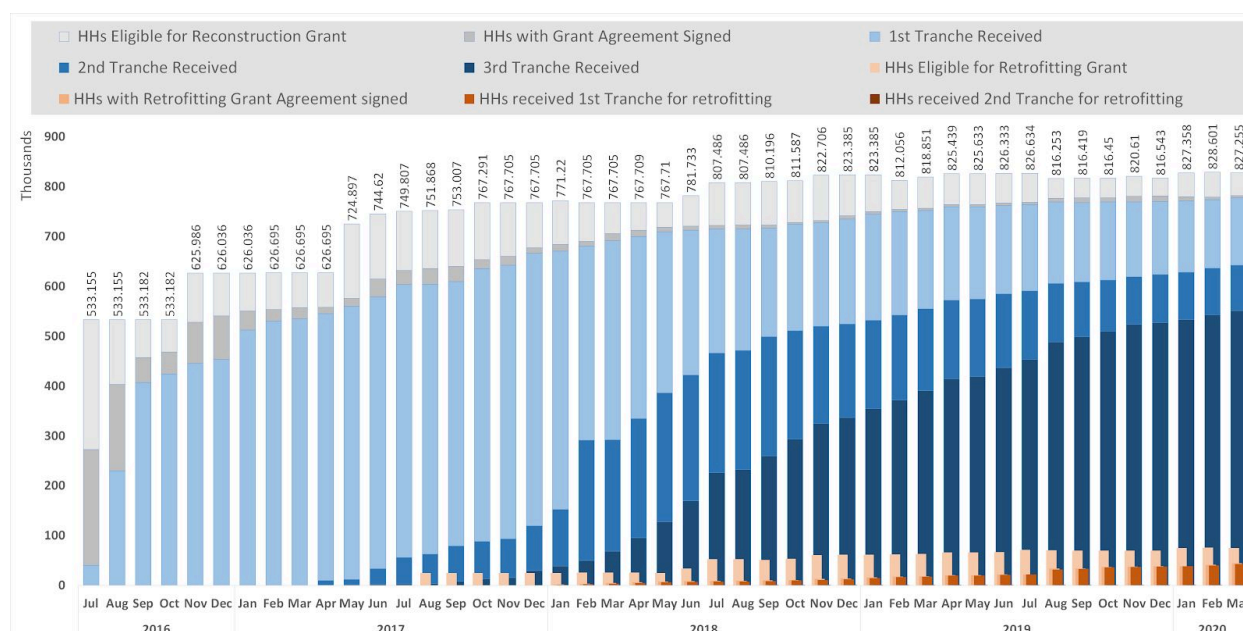


Ward 5, Changunarayan Municipality, Bhaktapur: three storey, brick in mud mortar house listed in retrofit grant scheme. After the observation of the house, District Support Engineer suggested that the house could be used as a demo house for retrofitting adopting wire mesh jacketing.

NATIONAL UPDATES

NRA, CLPIU GMAI and Building Grant Disbursement Data, as of 30 March 2020:

Reconstruction Grant	27 January	24 February	30 March
Total No. Eligible HHs	827358	828601	827255
HHs Enrolled	779125	778253	781176
HHs Received 1st Tranche	770861	773058	776953
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	639554	643431	648889
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	627909	635750	641994
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	3188	3154	2812
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	553777	557818	565075
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	532805	542597	550532
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	1949	1962	2214
Houses Completed	482794	484542	494044
HHs with Completion Certificate	77338	80718	83019
Retrofit Grant	27 January	24 February	30 March
Total No. Eligible HHs	74678	75435	74745
HHs Enrolled	38399	41166	44115
HHs Received 1st Tranche	37872	39520	42854
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	36	43	81



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMaLI CLPIU data as of 30 March 2020.

COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update

With the arrival of COVID-19 (Coronavirus) global pandemic in Nepal, the country has implemented a total lockdown on all movements until 8 April, and ban on international flights until 15 April thereby impacting on Nepal's recovery and reconstruction. So far, Nepal has 4 cases of Coronavirus positive, who are undergoing medical treatment, 1 recovered and 912 cases reported negative out of the total 917 tested for Coronavirus. All individuals are impacted by the suspension of flights and movement restriction in the whole country from 24 March 2020 onwards. Remote working modalities have been implemented and program continuity has been disrupted. In this context, we would like to request all partners and every individual to stay at home to stay safe to protect ourselves and the communities we live in from the COVID-19 pandemic.

Leveraging on the platform's multi-year experience, capacity, working relationship and status, HRRP can continue to contribute to COVID-19 response by providing coordination, information management and communication support to the Government of Nepal, Health cluster, Partner organizations and the local authorities. HRRP is willing to scale up the voluntary support it has already extended to Association of INGOS (AIN) and Health and Disaster Management Working Groups to bring together available information on COVID-19 through a [website](#) as well as preparedness and initial response planning through multiple surveys.

With the changing context and to ensure the safety of all staff and the stakeholders we support, HRRP has started to pilot work from home. HRRP plans to continuously adapt with the situation to identify key mission critical priorities and engagements.



"STAY HOME, STAY SAFE!"

NRA press statement to prevent and control COVID-19, March 2020: National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) requested all reconstruction and recovery stakeholders to take all precautionary measures to prevent and control COVID-19 pandemic and abide by the GoN decisions made by the COVID-19 Prevention and Control High Level Coordination Committee formed under the leadership of Deputy Prime Minister and Defence Minister, Rt. Hon. Mr. Ishwor Pokhrel on 18 March 2020.

International Conference update: National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) is engaging partners in the documentation of Nepal's reconstruction as part of preparation for the International Conference in November 2020 from three roots namely **scientific research papers** from individual Authors, **institutional reports** from reconstruction partners and **reconstruction compendium on six thematic areas** that include **housing; livelihood & economic recovery; heritage settlement; governance & institutional arrangement; social infrastructure; rescue & relief** among others. Accordingly, individual authors have

been communicated to write their full research papers within the given deadline (17 May). Institutions have been communicated to submit their draft institutional paper by the end of March. Likewise, six subcommittees have been formed to prepare Reconstruction Compendium under 6 themes as stated above. These subcommittees have organized initial meetings, have discussed the content outline for the Compendium, and have been communicated to prepare a draft report under each theme by the end of March. The International Conference Secretariat is providing necessary coordination support along with regular follow up to respective individuals and institutions in terms of their work progress and for relevant support from the Secretariat. However, with the COVID-19 (Coronavirus) global pandemic, and Nepal not remaining an exception, the NRA has issued a [notice](#) to all its CLPIUs and DLPIUs to provide leave to its staff members effective from 24 March 2020, and remain in contact with the office for official work as required throughout the lockdown period from 24 March onwards. The notice was issued in accordance with the decision of the cabinet meeting held on 23 March 2020. For more information contact: Mr. Manhoar Ghimire: reconstnra@gmail.com

NRA Partners' Project Tracking Sharing session, 18 March 2020: NRA NGO Section jointly with HRRP organized NRA partners' project tracking sharing session at NRA on 18 March. The objective was to share the current status of the NRA partner's projects signed with NRA to have uniform understanding on project activities carried out by different partners, their progress and completion status, the digitization of documents along with completion reports and to recommend strategic steps to mainstream project tracking into NRA MIS system. HRRP presented the overall project tracking process and highlighted the findings of the project tracking database, the number of projects against partners, financial expenditure by partners, details of project completion against ongoing projects, and financial audit report submission. In addition, the presentation highlighted project progress and completion reports disaggregated by sector and activity type like school construction, housing grant etc. support including monitoring visits carried out by NRA and Social Welfare Council (SWC) among others. The NRA CEO including the senior officials recommended that NGO section should further disaggregate partners' project tracking in terms of partner presence in the country, communication established with POs, budget spent by signing MOU with SWC, Finance Ministry (Off budget & on Budget), mechanism to verify the project activities at the district level and most importantly addressing comments

raised by the Office of the Auditor General. The CEO and the Executive Committee Members advised the NGO Section and HRRP to coordinate with the NRA MIS team and Foreign Aid Section at NRA to incorporate feedback and comments in the project tracking system.

Important points to remember while going through the appeal process by the non-beneficiaries: Last month, NRA issued a [public notice](#) against non-beneficiaries after the analysis of resurvey and reverification results conducted in 2075/2076 (2019/2020). Such beneficiaries if not satisfied with the resurvey and reverification results, can appeal at the Appeal Committee established at NRA, within 35 days of receiving non-beneficiary letter from DLPIU-GMaLI Office. An application can be filed either at DLPIU-GMaLI Office or directly at NRA Appeal Committee in Singh Durbar in Kathmandu with required documents. For detailed information, click [here](#).

Mobile Mason Training and Social Mobilizers Training: With Coronavirus cases now having been confirmed in Nepal, the Government of Nepal by the decision of the Office of the Prime Minister and Minister of Council, held on 23 March 2020, decided to lockdown the whole nation with restrictions on freedom of movement to prevent the spread of Coronavirus in Nepal. Pursuant to the decision of the Office of the Prime Minister and Minister of Council, NRA has issued a [notice](#) informing all CLPIUs and DLPIUs to provide leave to all the employees of CLPIUs and DLPIUs under NRA except for some key staffs required to operate office effective from 24 March 2020. In this regard, social mobilisation training events in the remaining 4 districts (Sindhuli, Ramechhap, Bhaktapur and Kavre) including all Mobile Masons training in 14 earthquake affected districts have been halted until further notice.

Asia Shelter Forum 2020, Nepal preparation update: The Second meeting of the Asia Shelter Forum Organizing Committee was held on 6 March 2020 with extended Organizing Committee Members. The members came together to discuss locking the date for the Forum and Global Shelter Cluster Regional Meeting to be held from 30 November to 2 December 2020 followed by NRA International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction. The Agenda and the theme of the event will be determined based on a survey to be shared with national, regional and global shelter practitioners.

The Urban Technical Working Group (UR-TWG): The UR-TWG is currently adapting their strategy in order to function remotely. The UR-TWG hopes to continue collaborating with POs under HRRP's facilitation, via email and Skype, on developing a comprehensive "Urban Recovery Strategy". The Urban Recovery Strategy is in its preliminary stages, and aims to address critical issues in efficient urban reconstruction and recovery: such as finance, land, policy and STA amongst others. Partners are requested to kindly contribute their experience and ideas to the development of the Strategy. The UR-TWG has completed a qualitative study and is in the midst of conducting a quantitative study on prioritizing urban recovery issues. The group will soon orient the trainers on the questionnaire remotely. However, the field survey component of the study has been put on hold until further notice due to the limitations arising from COVID-19.

Norms for Rate Analysis of Retrofitting Masonry Building (Draft Version) drafted by the Retrofitting Technical Working Group: A Retrofit Technical Working Group (R-TWG), was formed on 20th December 2019 to support the NRA, CLPIU Building to speed up retrofitting of buildings in earthquake affected areas through standardization of technical documents, solutions and approaches related to retrofitting. A number of documents related to retrofitting are under the preparation by the R-TWG for awareness raising in the community. This group consists of partner organizations, namely, NSET, Build Change, UNDP and HRRP who are actively working in retrofitting in the earthquake affected districts of Nepal. Norms for rate analysis of retrofitting masonry building is one of the main documents being prepared by the R-TWG since the last three months. This document provides basic guidelines of norms for load-bearing masonry structures. Please provide your comments and feedback to the TWG for standardization and final publication. For more information contact: Mr. Laxmi Prasad Bhatta, (National Technical Coordination Officer) techofficer2.national@hrrpnepal.org

OXFAM Bangladesh team visits Nepal to learn from Nepal's earthquake experience, 01 March 2020: A team from Bangladesh composed of Oxfam Bangladesh, City Corporation and NGO Forum for Public Health visited Nepal and interacted with various reconstruction stakeholders and shared their experiences on the community led DRR process supported by OXFAM Bangladesh. They met representatives from CLPIU-Building, HRRP, Nepal OXFAM team and interacted on various aspects of Nepal's earthquake

recovery and reconstruction process such as the NRA structure, its coordination mechanism, socio-technical assistance (STA) for private housing construction and its linkage to local government. They were also briefed on Nepal's sustainable technologies, alternative building technologies and materials such as hollow concrete bricks, its demand and supply, consumer perception, linkage to the private sector, and reconstruction policies and guidelines among others.



DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 20 Feb 2020 – 25 March 2020: during this period district coordination meetings and municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Kathmandu, Lalitpur, Dolakha, Ramechhap, Dhading, Makwanpur, Nuwakot, Sindhupalchok, Lamjung and Okhaldhunga. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

In **Kathmandu**, a meeting took place with the bank representatives on **15 March 2020**, to discuss banking updates, issues and challenges regarding the tranche distribution and subsidized loan procedures. It was noted that the banking sector has been working in coordination with GMaLI to address the issues of beneficiaries who have not claimed the first tranche. Some other challenges discussed were duplication in PA numbers, uploading the Payment Service Provider (PSP) in the system, change in beneficiary in case of death of beneficiary who had signed the agreement and the one in foreign employment. All banks including head offices and sub offices were requested to send the details of beneficiaries who did not claim the first tranche before July 2019 (Asadh 2076). Regarding the error in PA number and change in beneficiary details, GMaLI will coordinate with the banks and support the process, any such issues are also to be notified to GMaLI at the earliest, and banks were requested to report to GMaLI on a monthly basis.

In **Lalitpur**, DLPIU GMaLI Lalitpur conducted an interaction program with elected ward officials of Lalitpur Metropolitan City and the beneficiaries on **13 March 2020** to discuss and address the reconstruction issues of the beneficiaries. Mayor of Lalitpur Metropolitan City and NRA CEO were present to address the queries raised by the quake-affected people. Some of the concerns raised by the people and the local representatives were related to requirements of legal documents such as land ownership certificates and building permits. This was especially difficult to those people who are living in Government land, Guthi land or other lands not registered in Government record. NRA CEO, clarified that land ownership certificates, building permits including the completion certificates are important for future planning purposes of Municipalities and urban planning. Further, the CEO notified that NRA is in the process of handing over the ownership of housing reconstruction to local government with only the main grant disbursement to be taken care by authorized government agencies in order to handle large audit issues. In this regard, the CEO urged the local representatives to properly track the quake affected people, provide NRA with correct information on reconstruction beneficiaries and in facilitating the documents processing in time for successful completion of reconstruction program.

In **Dolakha, ward 1, Bigu Rural Municipality (26 February 2020)**, the meeting mainly discussed a way forward for completing the reconstruction of those beneficiaries remaining to start reconstruction. DLPIU Building emphasized on the completion of both reconstruction and retrofitting within the NRA timeframe. Ward Chief reported that people have completed reconstruction but have not received completion certificates, so decided to start the distribution of completion certificates from April 2020 (Baisakh 2077). Further, he focused on data collection related to other sectors such as livelihoods and gender-based programs. In **ward 8, Bhimeshwor Municipality (27 February 2020)**, the Ward Chief reported that most of the reconstruction work has been completed but people have not received the grants. He emphasized on completing the reconstruction by July 2020 (Asadh 2077) and starting the distribution of completion certificates. In **Wards 3 & 6, Jiri Municipality (3 – 4 March 2020)**, the meetings focused on to support the resettlement of

people living in hazard risk areas, to identify and address issues related to reconstruction. People were informed of the new NRA deadline for accessing the tranches. The meeting also discussed providing technical training on improved kitchen stoves to the quake affected households. In **Gaurishankar Rural Municipality (5 March 2020)**, the meeting was conducted with all the ward chiefs to discuss the reconstruction status in each ward. The Deputy Mayor highlighted that 12 households were swept by the landslide. The major concern is these households have already received all three tranches of Government reconstruction grant and they do not have any other land for settlement. In **ward 5, Gaurishankar Rural Municipality (6 March 2020)**, it was reported that most of the quake affected families have completed reconstruction of their houses but have not received the tranches on time. Delay in tranche disbursement has caused additional financial burden on some families who have taken loans at higher interest rates.

In **Ramechhap**, an interaction program was held in **ward 7, Ramechhap Municipality (5 March 2020)** that focused on the way forward for the retrofitting process. There are 38 households that are in the retrofit grant list and none of them are interested in retrofitting. They all have applied to be converted to reconstruction beneficiaries. A major concern ward engineer reported was that about 12 households under retrofit scheme have started reconstructing new houses after dismantling the retrofit eligible houses without getting the result of the conversion of beneficiary type. The District Support Engineer clarified that such issues have been reported throughout the districts and NRA is yet to make a decision on the matter related to households who have dismantled retrofitted eligible houses and constructed new ones.

In **Dhading**, a district coordination meeting was held on **28 February 2020**. There are 1,829 households categorized as vulnerable by the National Reconstruction Authority. Partner organizations briefed on the updates on their vulnerable support program. However, it was noted that vulnerable households supported by partners are to verify with the NRA vulnerable list to avoid duplication and with an aim to leave no one behind in the reconstruction process. Before providing the top up grant, commitment to be made by vulnerable families to reconstruct and complete within the time. It was proposed that NRA would mobilize the newly recruited social mobilizers and mobile masons in the areas where there have either not been partner organizations' social mobilizers and mobile masons' presence or gaps to avoid duplication of work and for larger coverage. During the District facilitation meeting that took place on **16 March 2020**, NRA new tranche deadline was shared along with reconstruction progress in the district. There are few beneficiaries whose names were listed twice, and names of those people have been provided to NRA along with the actual beneficiary's names for correction. A case was reported where people had taken grants twice in different names while living in the same house, they have been asked to return the first tranche. A case was also reported where two beneficiaries with the same names were mistaken for one. One beneficiary received the second tranche while the other one was refrained from the tranche process. This has been reported to NRA such

that the beneficiary gets the reconstruction grant. Discussion was also on supporting the resettlement of 54 families that are in hazard risk areas in ward 5, Gangajamuna Rural Municipality. These families have purchased land in ward 12 Nilkantha Municipality after getting a 200,000 NPR resettlement grant. Kaadorie was requested to support these people on housing reconstruction.

In **Makwanpur**, a meeting was organized with focal engineers on **25 February 2020** to discuss the current reconstruction progress and how to move ahead with the remaining reconstruction and complete the NRA timeframe. In addition, discussions were on the data collection timeframe and to push the retrofitting of load bearing structures. In **ward 7, Kailash Rural Municipality (16 March 2020)**, it was reported that retrofitting is quite slow, but reconstruction is moving at a good pace. Most houses in the ward are timber and hybrid structures. The technical persons and the people were told to complete reconstruction and receive the Government tranches on time. There are issues regarding the duplication in tranche where the people who have taken double tranche are requested to return the amount. Another important aspect discussed was to keep the data properly, reporting and distribution of reconstruction completion certificates.

In **Nuwakot**, district facilitation meeting held on **3 March 2020**, discussed on the removal of the names of the people who have been listed as reconstruction beneficiaries but have not done the partnership agreement by the given timeline of January 2020 (Poush 2076) and those who have taken first tranche and not started reconstruction. There were 1,026 households under those categories. The committee had extended the deadline for those people to contact GMaLI with reasons of not being able to start the reconstruction. Only 19 households came in contact and the list was sent to GMaLI. The meeting again proposed to extend the deadline till March 2020 (Falgun 2076). The meeting held on **11 March 2020** notified the extension of a new deadline to claim for the tranches and decided to release the first and second tranches of those people whose files have been received by GMaLI until 10 March 2020. In the meeting at **Dupcheshwor Rural Municipality (13 March 2020)**, the Chairperson noted a satisfactory progress in reconstruction in all wards of the Rural Municipality. There is also development of integrated settlement in ward 7 with support from OXFAM, where 74 households living in hazard risk areas in ward 1 have been relocated. There is also a lack of information on retrofitting due to which people are not interested in retrofitting.

In **Sindhupalchok**, an interaction program was held in **Jugal Rural Municipality (26 February 2020)** to discuss private housing reconstruction, land purchase for landless households, grievance handling and retrofitting to move the reconstruction ahead and complete on time.

In **Lamjung, ward 2, Dudhpokhari Rural Municipality (5 March 2020)**, discussions were on reconstruction of vulnerable households and one room houses. It was reported that some houses were completed a year before but have not received the tranches. These files

have been forwarded for release of tranches. Many people have not demolished their quake damaged houses. Most of the retrofit beneficiaries are willing to be on the reconstruction list.

In **Okhaldhunga, ward 2, Siddhicharan Municipality (2 March 2020)**, it was noted that retrofitting is moving at a good pace with support from Build Change. There are still issues related to houses built immediately after the earthquake who have not received the tranches from the Government. Some families have grievances of their houses not being included during the resurvey to be eligible for Government financial assistance.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 5, Changunarayan Municipality, Bhaktapur: Three storey, brick in mud mortar house listed in retrofit grant scheme. After the observation of the house, District Support Engineer suggested that the house could be used as a demo house for retrofitting adopting wire mesh jacketing.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 9, Gaurishankar Rural Municipality, Dolakha: Two storey with attic made up of stone in mud mortar with cement plaster and RCC bands. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 7, Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading: Two room, stone in mud mortar masonry with an attic. The homeowner is a single woman and is under the vulnerable category of the National Reconstruction Authority. The house has been constructed with technical and material support from PIN – Hamroghar as part of a vulnerable support program. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant. The total cost of construction is 400,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 8, Shankarapur Municipality, Kathmandu: Two storey, stone in mud mortar house listed under retrofit grant scheme. The homeowner is a single woman with two children under 16 years old. The District Support Engineer suggested Jacketing of the structure but the homeowner is unable to retrofit the house due to financial difficulties.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 12, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: Single storey, two room brick in cement mortar masonry. The homeowner has received all three tranches of Government housing grant. The house was completed with technical support from ASF Nepal and the total cost of construction is 700,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Chitwan, Nawalparasi Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 7, Kailash Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: four room, two storey, hybrid structure. The ground floor is made up of stone in mud and the upper floor is timber frame structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of Government housing grant. The total cost of construction is 500,000 NPR.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Rasuwa Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 7, Dupcheshwor Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Integrated settlement where 74 households from ward 1 have been relocated. The houses are made up of Compressed Stabilized Earth Bricks (CSEB) produced locally. The construction of the houses is supported by OXFAM.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Syangja Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 2, Dudhpokhari Rural Municipality, Lamjung: Four room, two storey, load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry with flexible CGI roof. The homeowner has received a second tranche of Government housing grant and applied for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 1, Jugal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: Two room, single storey, load bearing stone in mud mortar masonry. The homeowner has received a second tranche of Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Khotang, Solukhumbu Monthly Report, 20 Feb – 25 Mar 2020



Ward 2, Sotang Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: Two storey hybrid structure. The ground floor is stone in mud mortar and the upper floor is CGI with wooden bands with no partition wall. The homeowner has received a second tranche of Government housing grant. Few correction measures were suggested by the engineer after which he will be eligible for third tranche. The total cost of construction is 650,000 NPR.

FEATURED STORY



Featured Social Mobilizer, Devi Budhathoki, Although Devi had worked before with many other organizations as a Social Mobilizer, she had not participated in the “Four-day Social Mobilizers Training” conducted by NRA and Building, which changed her perspective towards housing construction. “I had no knowledge on earthquake resistant and complaint structures before at all”. The training was different, fruitful and relevant, and was life changing in terms of imparting knowledge and skills,” she notes. She had always thought that “people have the right to construct any type

of house they want." She had no idea why we needed to build a resilient house, how to build a safe house and how does an earthquake resistant house look like. But the training has completely changed her thinking now. "The training has equipped me with knowledge and skills on the importance of constructing compliant structures," she says.

"I gained coordination and communication skills throughout the training, aside from the technical knowledge of building resilient houses," says Devi. The training provided many other aspects such as disaster risk management, gender and social inclusion and knowledge on how to work inclusively in the communities to support reconstruction. She is strongly advocating with the communities in her working area to incorporate all the earthquake resistant elements and to make the houses compliant with Government Building Codes and Standards so that the beneficiaries receive the government grants in time and other associated benefits.

She feels very proud of her role as a social mobilizer especially in being able to assist those beneficiaries who are still struggling to complete reconstruction of their houses such as single women, senior citizens, households with only children, as well as households with weak financial conditions.

She is grateful for having received such a great opportunity for not only increasing her knowledge and skills about reconstruction work but also for an enriching experience for boosting self-confidence and personal developments/empowerment.



Featured Engineer, Nanda Kishor Yadav, is an Engineer working in Ward 14 of Nilkantha Municipality, Dhading. He joined NRA as an Engineer in November 2018.

Having worked with NRA for the last 1.5 years, Mr. Yadav says the reconstruction scenario is changing progressively with time. During the initial days, he was more engaged in raising awareness of the communities on safer housing reconstruction. He started with a very basic yet important part of building safer and resilient houses. He taught the communities how to lay the foundation, how to build plinth and tie beams, how to make connections of different elements of the building including the selection of land on which the

house is to be built.

In the beginning, it was difficult to convince people regarding safer reconstruction, he says, "but I am happy now to see the increased awareness among the people and to see reconstruction progressing to 93% in my working area and in remaining areas as well."

"I feel happy and proud to have got an opportunity to work in the reconstruction and contribute to the Government of Nepal in building resilient houses and communities," he says.

CASE STORY

Kanchan Thapa, Retrofit Beneficiary: Mr. Kanchan Thapa is from Ward No. 5, of Suryabinayak Municipality, Bhaktapur. He has been listed under the retrofitting grant of the Government retrofitting program and has received the first tranche amount 50,000 NPR. He retrofitted his two-story with attic, load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry house by applying wall jacketing as advised by his neighbor, who is a Structural Engineer. Mr. Thapa was supported in designing and during the process of retrofitting.

Mr. Kanchan said it took almost 4 months to complete retrofitting and he spent about 25,00,000 NPR for retrofitting his house that included labour charge, food for labour, house painting. He is happy that his house is strong, and he feels safe living in an earthquake resilient house now.



House of Mr. Kanchan Thapa, ward 5, Suryabinayak Municipality, during and after the retrofitting process. Wall Jacketing used in the interior and exterior of the house.

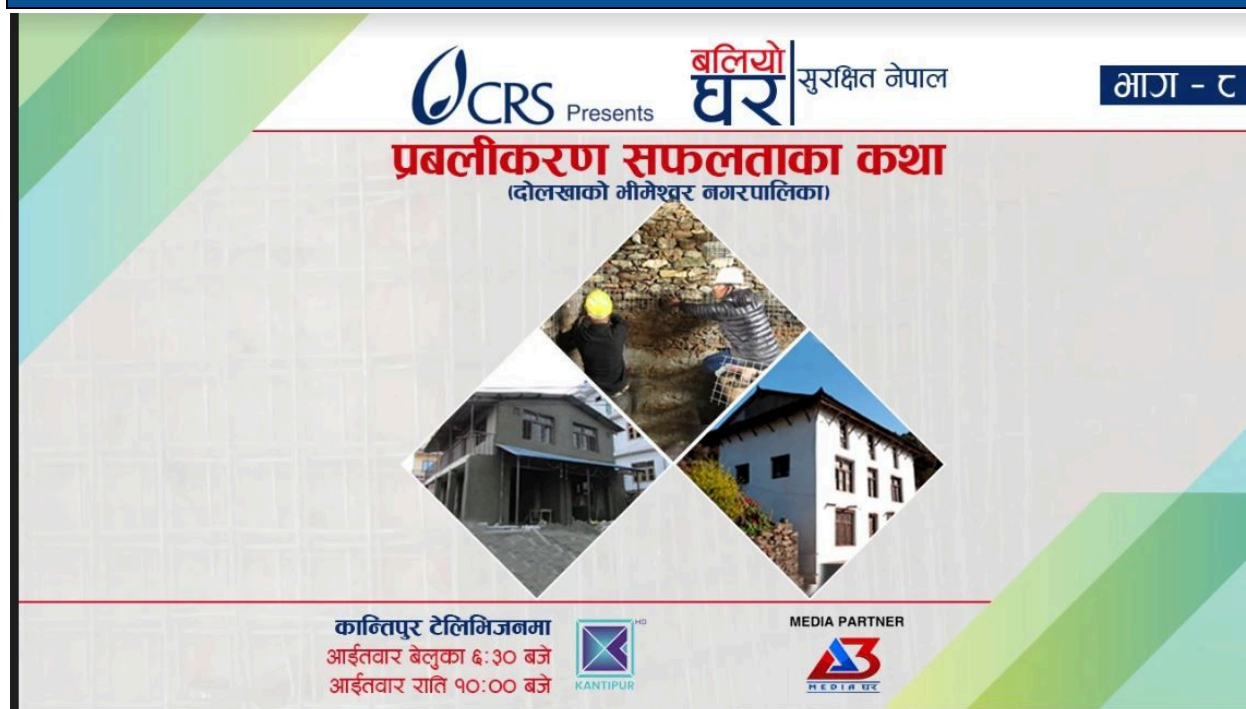
Mrs. Bhim Maya Sunuwar, Reconstruction beneficiary of Khijidemba Rural Municipality, ward no. 3, Okhaldhunga: Mrs. Bhim Maya Sunuwar is 56 years old. She lives in Ward 3 of Khijidemba Rural Municipality in Okhaldhunga. Almost 10 years ago, Bhim Maya lost her husband and three children in a landslide. It had not been long before the 2015 Earthquake again devastated her life. The earthquake damaged her house and she was forced to live in a temporary shelter. She is one of the beneficiaries listed in the vulnerable category for the reconstruction grant as categorized by the NRA. Even then, it was difficult for her to construct a house. Thanks to CRS vulnerable support program from

which she got top-up support of 50,000 NPR for the construction of a single room stone in mud mortar house. She is now very happy to be living in an earthquake resilient house.



She is also one of the participants of the Cash for Work program implemented by Demba Community Development Center, a CRS partner through which she is earning for her livelihood. "I am also saving some money from this work," said Bhim Maya.

MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



CRS Presents **बलियो घर** सुरक्षित नेपाल

प्रबलीकरण सफलताका कथा
(दोलखाको भीमेश्वर नगरपालिका)

कान्तिपुर टेलिभिजनमा
आइतवार बेलुका ६:३० बजे
आइतवार राति १०:०० बजे

KANTIPUR

MEDIA PARTNER
3 MEDIA PARTNER

Baliyo Ghar | Episode - 179 | 22 March 2020: This episode discusses successful stories of retrofitting in Dolakha. Interactions with retrofitting beneficiaries, Municipal Mayor, Ward Chairpersons, Field Engineers, Masons reveal that retrofitting has been successful in Dolakha and more and more beneficiaries are now retrofitting their houses. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 22 March 2020 at 6:30 & 10:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority February 2020

HRRP PRODUCTS



Palika Profiles (Municipal reconstruction profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

PARTNER PRODUCTS

Covid-19: How to engage marginalized and vulnerable people in risk communication and community engagement: Regional Risk Communication and Community Engagement (RCEE) Working Group, an inter-agency coordination platform developed this guideline to provide technical support on risk communication and community engagement to novel coronavirus outbreak preparedness and response in Asia and the Pacific. The guideline explicitly outlines the importance of understanding issues of vulnerable populations in order for us to provide priority assistance and engage them in decision-making processes for response, recovery, preparedness and risk reduction.

Helpline Services: Considering the psychosocial impact of the recent COVID-19, Transcultural Psychosocial Organization (TPO) Nepal has extended its helpline services to everyone who is in need. They provide both psychosocial and mental health services. Individuals and partners are encouraged to use this service from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM everyday. TPO Nepal **HELPLINE Toll Free Number: 1660 01 0 2005** (call to this number is free of cost from NTC network).

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